

Word family: **sustainable / sustainably / sustainability / unsustainable / sustain**

Target word: sustainable

Related forms: sustainably, sustainability, unsustainable, unsustainably, sustain

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞)

Related noun/adverb/verb: sustainability (名詞) , sustainably (副詞) , sustain (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “That is neither fair nor **sustainable**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **sustainable** means **able to continue for a long time without creating costs, pressures, or problems that eventually make the situation impossible to maintain**.

The writer argues that restaurants cannot reasonably keep absorbing the costs of long-stay tutorial use indefinitely.

繁體中文： **可長期維持的；能夠持續下去而不造成無法承受的成本、壓力或後果的**

中文翻譯：

> “That is neither fair nor **sustainable**.”

「那既不公平，也**無法長久維持 / 不可持續**。」

Here:

sustainable = 這種做法長期下去仍然能夠維持，而不會因成本、壓力或其他問題最終崩潰

1. **sustainable = able to continue for a long time (一般) — 可持續的；能長久維持的**

This is the **exact passage sense**.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The current arrangement is not **sustainable**.”

「目前的安排**無法長久維持 / 不可持續**。」

Practice 2

> “Working fourteen hours every day is not **sustainable**.”

「每天工作十四小時並不是一種**可以長期維持的**生活方式。」

Practice 3

> “The company needs a more **sustainable** growth strategy.”

「公司需要一套更**能長期維持的**增長策略。」

****sustainable = 某種做法、速度、制度或狀態可以長時間維持，而不會因資源不足、成本過高、壓力過大等原因無法繼續****

Common:

- * sustainable growth
- * sustainable pace
- * sustainable business model
- * sustainable solution
- * sustainable system
- * sustainable level

2. ****sustainable = environmentally responsible over the long term (環境) — 環境可持續的；永續的****

This is now one of the most prominent meanings.

****Meaning:**** Using natural resources and organizing human activity in a way that can continue without causing serious long-term environmental damage or exhausting resources.

Practice 4

> “The city is investing in more **sustainable** transport.”

「這座城市正投資發展更**環境可持續的 / 永續的**交通方式。」

Practice 5

> “Consumers are increasingly interested in **sustainable** products.”

「消費者越來越關注**環境可持續的**產品。」

****sustainable = 在滿足現有需要的同時，不以長期破壞環境或耗盡自然資源為代價****

Common:

- * sustainable development
- * sustainable transport
- * sustainable agriculture
- * sustainable food
- * sustainable design
- * sustainable tourism
- * sustainable production

This is a major specialized-but-everyday branch.

3. **sustainable = using a resource without exhausting it (資源) — 可持續利用的 ; 不會耗盡資源的**

This environmental use can focus specifically on keeping extraction/use within a level that the resource can replenish or support.

Practice 6

> “Fishing must remain at a **sustainable** level.”

「捕魚量必須維持在**可持續的水平**，不能令魚類資源枯竭。」

Practice 7

> “The forest is managed for **sustainable** timber production.”

「這片森林以**可持續方式**管理木材生產。」

sustainable use/yield = 資源使用速度不超過其恢復、補充或長期承受能力

For core counting, this belongs to Meaning 2.

4. **sustainable = financially/economically viable over time (商業 / 經濟) — 財務上可持續的 ; 能長期生存的**

A company, service, pricing model, or financial arrangement can be **sustainable** if it can keep operating economically.

Practice 8

> “The business needs a financially **sustainable** model.”

「這家企業需要一個財務上**能長期維持的**商業模式。」

Practice 9

> “The programme is useful, but its current funding model is not **sustainable**.”

「這項計劃很有用，但目前的資金模式**無法長期維持**。」

****financially sustainable = 收入、資金和成本結構足以讓一項活動或機構長期運作****

This is especially close to your passage because the writer is discussing restaurant costs.

5. ****sustainable = manageable without excessive human pressure/burnout (工作 / 生活) — 可長期承受的****

****Sustainable**** can describe a workload, routine, pace, or lifestyle that a person can maintain without exhaustion or breakdown.

Practice 10

> “We need a more **sustainable** workload.”

「我們需要一個更**能長期承受的**工作量。」

Practice 11

> “This pace is not **sustainable** for the staff.”

「這種工作節奏對員工來說**不能長久維持**。」

This is not environmental. It is the general “continue without eventually failing” sense.

6. ****sustainable = capable of being supported or defended by evidence/reasoning (論點) — 站得住腳的；可成立的****

There is also a formal meaning:

> ****a sustainable argument / claim / position****

can mean one that can be logically or evidentially maintained.

Practice 12

> “That conclusion is not **sustainable** on the available evidence.”

「按照現有證據，那個結論**難以成立 / 站不住腳**。」

Practice 13

> “The argument is legally and logically **sustainable**.”

「這個論點在法律和邏輯上都**可以成立 / 能夠維持**。」

sustainable = 有足夠理由、證據或法律依據支持，因此可以繼續主張或維持

This is a genuine formal/legal/academic branch.

7. **sustainable** = capable of being legally upheld/maintained (法律) — 法律上可成立 / 可維持的

In legal writing, a claim, decision, objection, finding, or position may be described as **sustainable** if it can be upheld under the law or evidence.

Practice 14

> “The court considered whether the claim was legally **sustainable**.”

「法院考慮該項主張在法律上是否**站得住腳 / 可以成立**。」

This is closely related to Meaning 6 and should normally be merged with it.

Related form: **sustainably**

Sustainably means in a way that can continue long term, especially without environmental damage or excessive resource use.

Practice 15

> “The fish were caught **sustainably**.”

「這些魚是以**可持續方式**捕撈的。」

Practice 16

> “The organization needs to grow **sustainably**.”

「這個機構需要以**能長期維持的方式**發展。」

The Chinese translation depends on context:

* environmentally → **以環境可持續方式**

* business/growth → **以可長期維持的方式**

Related form: **sustainability**

Sustainability mirrors the main senses of **sustainable**.

sustainability = ability to continue long term (持續能力)

Practice 17

> “They questioned the long-term **sustainability** of the project.”

「他們質疑這個項目的長期**可持續性**。」

sustainability = environmental sustainability (環境永續 / 可持續發展)

Practice 18

> “The company has introduced new **sustainability** targets.”

「公司訂立了新的**可持續發展 / 環境永續**目標。」

In modern corporate and environmental contexts, bare **sustainability** often strongly implies environmental and social resource use, although the exact scope depends on context.

financial sustainability = 財務可持續性

> “The review focuses on the financial sustainability of the service.”

「這次檢討集中研究該服務的**財務可持續性**。」

Related form: **unsustainable**

Unsustainable is extremely important.

It means something **cannot continue indefinitely under its present conditions**.

Practice 19

> “The current level of spending is **unsustainable**.”

「目前的支出水平**無法長期維持**。」

Practice 20

> “The farming method is environmentally **unsustainable**.”

「這種耕作方式在環境上**不可持續**。」

Practice 21

> “Staff are working at an **unsustainable** pace.”

「員工正在以一種**無法長久承受的節奏**工作。」

This is the direct opposite of **sustainable**.

Related verb: **sustain**

The adjective ultimately comes from **sustain**, and several meanings are useful for understanding the family.

sustain = keep something going/maintain it (維持)

Practice 22

> “The business cannot **sustain** this level of spending.”

「企業無法**維持 / 承擔**這種支出水平。」

This is the branch directly behind **sustainable**.

**sustain = support life/activity (支撐) **

> “The land cannot sustain such a large population.”

「這片土地無法**供養 / 支撐**這麼龐大的人口。」

sustain = suffer/experience damage, injury, or loss (正式) — 遭受

Practice 23

> “The building **sustained** serious damage.”

「這棟建築物**遭受**嚴重損壞。」

Common:

* sustain damage

* sustain injuries

* sustain losses

This is a separate meaning of **sustain**, not a separate meaning of **sustainable**.

sustain = uphold a legal objection/decision (法律) — 支持；維持

> “The judge sustained the objection.”

「法官**接納 / 維持**該項反對。」

Again, this helps explain formal **sustainable = capable of being upheld**.

Important distinction: **sustainable vs renewable**

This is one of the most important environmental distinctions.

renewable

means the resource can naturally replenish.

Examples:

* solar energy

* wind energy

sustainable

means its use can continue long-term without unacceptable environmental, economic, or social damage.

Something can be renewable but still used in an unsustainable way.

So:

> renewable ≠ automatically sustainable

Important distinction: **sustainable vs green**

green

is a broad informal label suggesting environmental friendliness.

sustainable

is more precise and emphasizes **long-term viability/resource balance**.

> green packaging

> sustainable production system

A product can be marketed as “green” without demonstrating full long-term sustainability.

Important distinction: **sustainable vs environmentally friendly**

environmentally friendly

means causing relatively little harm to the environment.

sustainable

asks a broader long-term question:

> can this system continue without exhausting resources or creating unacceptable future damage?

They overlap, but **sustainable** is broader.

Important distinction: **sustainable vs viable**

viable

means capable of working successfully or surviving.

sustainable

means capable of **continuing over time**.

Compare:

> “The idea is viable.”

= 它行得通。

> “The model is sustainable.”

= 它可以長期維持。

A plan may be viable in the short term but unsustainable over many years.

Important distinction: **sustainable vs feasible**

feasible

means practically possible to do.

sustainable

means possible to keep doing.

> feasible today

> sustainable for ten years

This distinction is very useful.

Important distinction: **sustainable vs maintainable**

****maintainable****

means capable of being kept in good condition or continued.

****sustainable****

often additionally emphasizes:

- * resources
- * long-term pressure
- * economics
- * environmental impact

In software engineering, ****maintainable**** is usually more natural for code that is easy to update or repair.

Important distinction: ****sustainable vs durable****

****durable****

means physically able to resist wear/damage.

****sustainable****

means able to continue as a system/practice.

- > durable shoes
- > sustainable manufacturing

Different concepts.

Important distinction: ****sustainable vs stable****

****stable****

means not changing suddenly or becoming unstable.

****sustainable****

means capable of continuing.

A growth rate might be:

> stable but unsustainable

if it remains constant yet consumes resources too quickly.

Important distinction: **sustainable growth vs endless growth**

Sustainable growth does not simply mean:

> growth that never stops.

It normally means:

> growth that can continue without eventually producing financial, operational, environmental, or other constraints that make continuation impossible.

Context determines which constraints matter.

Grammar note: **sustainable + noun**

Very common:

- * sustainable development
- * sustainable growth
- * sustainable business
- * sustainable solution
- * sustainable agriculture
- * sustainable transport
- * sustainable energy
- * sustainable lifestyle
- * sustainable pace

The Chinese translation should follow the domain rather than mechanically translating every case identically.

Grammar note: **sustainable for + person/system**

> “This workload is not sustainable for staff.”

= 這個工作量對員工而言無法長期承受。

Grammar note: **sustainable in the long term**

A very common reinforcement:

> “The model is financially sustainable in the long term.”

「這個模式從長遠而言在財務上可以持續。」

Family-extension note

The practical family includes:

* **sustain**
* **sustains**
* **sustained**
* **sustaining**
* **sustainable**
* **sustainably**
* **sustainability**
* **unsustainable**
* **unsustainably**

The conceptual centre is:

> **keep something going over time**

From that develop:

* long-term operational sustainability
* environmental sustainability
* financial sustainability
* sustainable workloads/paces
* arguments or legal positions that can be maintained

The family verb **sustain** has additional independent meanings—especially **sustain damage/injury**—that should not be mistaken for adjective senses of **sustainable**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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sustainable — general	能夠長時間繼續，而不因成本、壓力或資源不足而最終無法維持	
sustainable — environmental	能長期使用資源而不造成嚴重環境破壞或耗盡資源的	
sustainable use/yield	使用 / 開採量不超過資源長期補充及承受能力的	
financially sustainable	收入、資金及成本結構足以讓活動 / 機構長期運作的	
sustainable workload/pace	人可以長時間承受而不致過勞或崩潰的	
sustainable — argument/legal	有足夠證據、理由或法律基礎支持，因而站得住腳 / 可以維持的	
sustainability	某制度、做法或資源模式能夠長期持續的能力 / 可持續性	
unsustainable	在目前條件下無法長時間繼續的；不可持續的	
sustain — maintain	使某事持續 / 維持某種狀態或水平	
sustain damage/injury	遭受損害 / 受傷；屬於 sustain 的獨立正式義	
sustain an objection	法律上接納 / 維持反對；屬於 sustain 的法律義	

For your original sentence

> “That is neither fair nor ****sustainable****.”

The exact meaning is:

****sustainable = 餐廳長期承受桌位被佔用、營業額損失和隱藏營運成本的模式能否一直維持下去****

The writer's answer is no.

So:

> ****not sustainable****

= ****無法長久維持 / 長遠而言行不通****

It does ****not primarily mean “not environmentally friendly”**** here. That is an important modern meaning of the word, but the passage is using the broader long-term viability sense.

For your database, I would count ****4 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****sustainable****:

1. ****able to continue or be maintained over the long term****
2. ****environmentally/resource sustainable****
3. ****financially/operationally sustainable**** — important domain realization of #1, worth surfacing
4. ****formally defensible/maintainable as an argument, claim, or legal position****

I would keep ****sustainable workload/pace**** under #1, resource-use applications under #2, and treat ****sustainability / sustainably / unsustainable**** as major family extensions.